INCH-POUND

MIL-W-1053G
12 July 1989
SUPERSEDING
MIL-W-1053F
12 December 1979

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

WHISTLE, BALL, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic ball whistles for use by Military personnel.

1.2 Classification. The whistle shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - with helical split ring
Type II - with lanyard

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-349 - Plastic Molding and Extrusion Material, Cellulose Acetate Butyrate
FF-R-556 - Rivet, Solid, Small; Rivet, Split, Small; Rivet Tubular, Small; Flat Washer (Burr); and Cap, Rivet; General Purpose
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

MILITARY

MIL-B-371 - Braid, Textile, Tubular

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 787 - Ethyl Cellulose Molding and Extrusion Compounds
D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Plastic. The plastic shall be virgin cellulose acetate butyrate conforming to grade MH of L-P-349 or ethyl cellulose conforming to type I, grade 4 of ASTM D 787. Up to 15 percent by weight of scrap material of the same composition as the virgin material will be allowed in any one batch of molding compound.

3.1.2 Cork ball. Cork for the ball shall be XX quality natural cork or better or cork composition of a clean soft grade uniformly granulated.

3.1.3 Lanyard. The lanyard for the type II whistle shall be made from cotton tubular braid conforming to type IV, class 1 of MIL-B-371. The color of the braid shall approximate Black 174 and have good fastness to crocking and laundering (3 cycles). The length of the braid shall be 37 inches. Ends shall be resin dipped or tipped to prevent fraying. The color of the tips shall be dyed grey or black. Alternately the lanyard shall be 5/32 ± 1/64 inch diameter nylon or polyester solid or diamond braid, dyed black and have good fastness to crocking and laundering (3 cycles). The ends of the braid shall be heat sealed in such a manner as to permit easy access through the eyelet.

3.1.4 Slide keeper. The slide keeper shall be extruded vinyl chloride-acetate copolymer plastic or polyvinyl chloride. The keeper shall be flexible, black in color, approximately 1/2 inch in length and compatible with the lanyard.

3.1.5 Helical split ring. The split ring for the type I whistle shall be formed from steel wire, spring tempered, and nickel plated. The ring dimensions shall be approximately 0.750 inches in height with an inside diameter of 0.100 inches (see 6.3).

3.1.6 Eyelet. The eyelet for the split construction whistle shall be a rolled flange eyelet made from commercial 0.0105 inch thick brass conforming to the following dimensions with tolerances as indicated:

Flange diameter	- 0.290 ± 0.005 inch
Outside diameter	- 0.183 ± 0.002 inch
Length under flange	- 0.344 ± 0.005 inch

The finish of the eyelet shall be a natural brass.

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3.1.7 Rivet, brass, flat countersunk head. The rivet for the split construction whistle shall be a flat countersunk-head, 1/8 inch body diameter rivet conforming to type X, grade F of FF-R-556 except that the brass shall be annealed or eighth hard. The rivet shall have a natural finish.

3.2 Design and construction. The design and construction of the type I whistle with helical ring shall be in accordance with figure 2. The design and construction of the type II whistle with lanyard shall be in accordance with either figure 1 or figure 2. The two halves of the split construction whistle shall be permanently joined with a suitable adhesive prior to adding the rivet and eyelet.

3.3 Color. The color of the whistle shall approximate color No. 14087 (Olive Drab) of FED-STD-595.

3.4 Marking for identification. Each whistle body shall be permanently and distinctly marked with the letters "U.S", the name of manufacturer or brand name, and the year of manufacture. The size of the letters shall be approximately 3/32 inch high.

3.5 Assembly.

a. The lanyard with slide keeper shall be attached to the type II whistles as shown on figures 1 and 2. The length of the finished lanyard shall approximate 15-1/2 inches and the ends of the cord shall be knotted (see 6.2).

b. The helical split ring shall be attached to the type I whistle as shown on figure 2 (see 6.2).

3.6 Workmanship. The end item shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Certificate of compliance. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance certifying that the items being furnished comply with the stated requirements. The Government reserves the right to inspect the item to verify the certification and may reject any item or lot of items when it is determined that:

a. Any required component or design characteristic is missing or not as specified herein.

b. Any aspects of design, construction, assembly, function or finish is not in accordance with good commercial practice.

c. Any packaging or marking is not in accordance with requirements.

4.3 Component, material and packaging certification. A certificate of compliance may be acceptable as evidence that the components, materials and packaging conform to the requirements specified in 3.1 through 3.5 and 5.1 - 5.3.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A preservation.

5.1.1.1 Unit packing. Each completely assembled whistle shall be unit packed in a wrapper, bag, or envelope made of clear polyethylene film of 0.00125 inch thickness (± 25 percent tolerance).

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packing. Twenty five whistles of one type only, unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed in an intermediate folding paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III, type G class 1, sub-class 1 of PPP-B-566; or in a setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676.

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5.1.2 Commercial preservation. The whistles shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing Packing shall be level B or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level B packing. Five hundred whistles of one type only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.1 Weather-resistent containers. When specified (see 6.2), shipping containers shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Commercial packing. Whistles, preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packs and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The plastic whistle is intended for use by military personnel performing police, guard, drill instruction, and other duties which require the use of whistles. Type I whistles are required by the Marine Corps only.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of whistle and the assembly required (see 1.2, 3.5 and 6.3).
c. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
d. Levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. When weather resistent grade fiberboard shipping containers required for level B packing (see 5.2.1.1).

6.3 Key ring. Three-quarter inch diameter, spring tempered, nickel plated, steel key rings made by American Chain & Cable Co., York, PA 17405 have been found suitable for the intended purpose.

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6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Drill
Music
Police
Shrill
Sound

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MC
Air Force - 82
DLA - CT

User activities:
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - GL

(Project 8465-0021)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-W-1053G	WHISTLE, BALL, PLASTIC

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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